

Download Latest List of Businesses For Sale:

 **Live Current Business Listings.pdf**

Florida Relocation Acquisition Guide

A playbook for business owners considering selling in New York, New Jersey, Illinois, and other high-tax states — and acquiring like-kind businesses in Florida.



Prepared by SavingsRE

Bill Seery, MBA, Realtor

 917-805-4262

 bill@savingsre.com

Table of Contents

Table of Contents	2
Section 1: Executive Summary	4
Section 2: Florida vs High-Tax States — Financial Impact	5
2.1 Tax Comparison Snapshot	5
2.2 Example: \$2.5M Business Sale Scenario	5
2.3 CRITICAL POINT —>>> Why the Timing Matters	6
3. Preparing Your Business for Sale (12-Month Exit Roadmap)	7
3.1 12-Month Business Exit Timeline	7
3.2 Financial Preparation & Add-Backs (EBITDA Normalization)	8
3.3 Documents to Prepare Before Selling	9
3.4 Should You Sell Assets or Stock?	10
4. Acquiring a Business in Florida (Step-by-Step Playbook)	11
4.1 Step-by-Step Acquisition Framework	11
4.2 Sample Letter of Intent (LOI) Structure	12
4.3 Financial Nursing: SBA Loans, Seller Financing & Equity	13
4.4 Due Diligence Checklist (What to Verify)	13
4.5 Transition Plan After Closing (30/60/90 Days)	14
5. Florida Industries in Demand & Valuation Metrics	15
5.1 Top Industries & Typical Valuation Multiples	15
5.2 Why These Industries Thrive in Florida	16
5.3 Pricing Example — HVAC Company Acquisition in Florida	16
5.4 Pricing Example — Medspa / Wellness Clinic in Palm Beach	16
5.5 Where Buyers Are Focusing in 2025	17
6. Advanced Tax, Residency & Legal Strategy	18
6.1 Establishing Florida Residency (Domicile Checklist)	18
6.2 Avoiding High-Tax State Residency Audits	19
6.3 Capital Gains — How to Legally Pay \$0 in State Taxes	20
6.4 Entity Structuring When Re-Establishing in Florida	21
6.5 1031 Exchange & Asset Swap Strategies	21
6.6 Florida Homestead + Asset Protection Benefits	22
7. Florida Relocation Checklist	23
✓ 7.1 Business Sale & Exit Preparation (Pre-Relocation)	23
✓ 7.2 Florida Entity Setup & Acquisition Preparation	24
✓ 7.3 Legal Residency Transition — Avoiding “Sticky State Taxation”	25
✓ 7.4 Relocation: Personal & Operational Checklist	26
✓ 7.5 Post-Acquisition & Integration Checklist (Florida Business)	27
✓ 7.6 Optional: Business & Personal Insurance Checklist in Florida	27
8. Case Studies: Real-World Relocation & Acquisition Success	29

• Case Study 1: New York Restaurant Group → Miami Franchise Operator	29
• Case Study 2: New Jersey Physical Therapy Practice → Palm Beach Rehab & Wellness Center	30
• Case Study 3: Illinois Manufacturing Business → Tampa Distribution & E-Commerce	30
• Case Study 4: Tech Entrepreneur from California → Software + Service Roll-Up in Orlando	31
9. Templates, Tools & Appendices	33
9.1 Sample Letter of Intent (LOI) – Business Acquisition	33
9.2 EBITDA / SDE Add-Back Template (Copy to Google Sheets)	35
9.3 183-Day Residency Log (To Defend Against NY/NJ/CA Audits)	36
9.4 Business-For-Sale Websites & Florida Broker List	37
Online Deal Search Platforms	37
Florida-Based Business Brokers (Top Firms)	37
9.5 Moving & Legal Contacts	38

Section 1: Executive Summary

Thousands of business owners in states like New York, New Jersey, Illinois, and California are exiting their companies and relocating to Florida — driven by high taxes, estate planning issues, regulatory burdens, and lifestyle considerations.

Florida offers:

- 0% state income tax
- Lower capital gains exposure when structured correctly
- Asset protection, homestead laws, and favorable estate planning
- A rapidly growing economy with strong population and business migration

This guide will help you:

- ✓ Strategically sell your business in a high-tax state and maximize your exit value
 - ✓ Acquire or relocate a like-kind business in Florida with lower taxes and higher ROI
 - ✓ Avoid legal pitfalls, residency audit issues, and financing mistakes
 - ✓ Follow a clear, step-by-step roadmap to transition your wealth, business, and life
-

Section 2: Florida vs High-Tax States — Financial Impact

2.1 Tax Comparison Snapshot

Tax Category	Florida	New York	New Jersey	California
State Income Tax	0%	Up to 13.4%	Up to 10.75%	Up to 14.4%
State Capital Gains	0%	Taxed as income	Taxed as income	Taxed as income
Corporate Income Tax	5.5%	7.25–9.5%	9%	8.84%
Estate/Inheritance Tax	None	Yes (estate tax)	Yes (inheritance)	None
Property Tax	Moderate	High	High	High
Cost of Living Index	101 (U.S.=100)	148	121	152

2.2 Example: \$2.5M Business Sale Scenario

Scenario	Sell & Stay in NY	Sell in NY → Relocate to FL Before Sale
Sale Price	\$2,500,000	\$2,500,000
Federal Capital Gains (20% + 3.8%)	-\$597,500	-\$597,500
NY State Taxes (~10%)	-\$250,000	\$0
Approx. Legal/CPA Fees	-\$35,000	-\$40,000 (includes relocation planning)

Net to Seller	\$1,617,500	\$1,902,500
Tax Savings by Establishing FL Residency		+\$285,000

2.3 CRITICAL POINT —>>> Why the Timing Matters

- ✓ You must establish Florida residency before selling the business to avoid “sticky state” taxation
- ✓ Requires cutting ties with prior state (domicile test)
- ✓ Documentation examples: driver’s license, voter registration, 183-day rule, declaration of domicile, moving primary home, doctor/banking in FL

3. Preparing Your Business for Sale (12-Month Exit Roadmap)

Selling a business for maximum value — especially in a high-tax state like NY, NJ, CA, or IL — requires 6–12 months of preparation. Buyers and lenders (especially SBA-backed lenders) will pay more for businesses with clean financials, transferable operations, and proof of stable or growing cash flow.

3.1 12-Month Business Exit Timeline

Timeframe	Key Actions	Deliverables
12–9 Months Before Listing	• Engage CPA for tax planning and entity review • Conduct internal valuation & normalize financials (add-backs) • Resolve outstanding legal or compliance issues • Begin reducing personal expenses run through business	• Clean P&Ls & balance sheets (3 years) • Add-back worksheet • Preliminary valuation
9–6 Months Before Listing	• Create or update operating procedures (SOPs) • Train or promote key managers to reduce owner reliance • Optimize KPIs (AR days, inventory, margin improvement) • Gather major contracts & client agreements	• Documented SOPs • Updated org chart • Contract & vendor list
6–3 Months Before Listing	• Hire business broker or M&A advisor • Prepare Confidential Information Memorandum (CIM/CBR) • Finalize adjusted EBITDA calculations • Decide asset vs stock sale strategy with tax advisor	• Completed CIM/CBR (20–40 pages) • Broker engagement agreement • Financial summary package

3–1 Months	• Confirm asking price & deal structure (cash, seller financing, earnout)	• Buyer-ready documentation folder
Before Listing	• Stage business for buyer site visits • Prepare due diligence room (Dropbox/Google Drive)	• Transitional employment contract (if staying post-sale)
At Listing & Post-Listing	• Begin marketing to qualified buyers • Screen NDAs • Manage site visits, questions, LOIs • Prepare for due diligence and bank SBA underwriting	• Signed offers/LOIs • Negotiating purchase agreement • Tax prep on timing of gain recognition

3.2 Financial Preparation & Add-Backs (EBITDA Normalization)

Buyers evaluate businesses based on SDE (Seller’s Discretionary Earnings) or EBITDA. To maximize valuation, you must clearly document “add-backs” — expenses that reduce profit on paper but won’t carry over to a buyer.

Common Add-Back Examples:

- Owner salary and perks (cars, health insurance, travel)
- Family payroll not essential to business
- One-time legal or consulting fees
- Rent adjustments (if property is owned by seller)
- Depreciation and amortization (non-cash expenses)

Example: Calculating Adjusted EBITDA

Description	Amount
Net Profit (per tax return)	\$450,000
+ Owner Salary	\$180,000

+ Owner Health Insurance	\$12,000
+ Depreciation	\$25,000
+ One-time legal fees	\$15,000
- Excess market rent adjustment	(\$10,000)
= Seller's Discretionary Earnings (SDE)	\$672,000

If your business sells at 3.5× SDE → \$2,352,000 sale value

3.3 Documents to Prepare Before Selling



Financial Documents

- 3 years of business tax returns
- 3 years of profit & loss & balance sheets
- Current YTD financials
- Business debt schedule (loans, liens, leases)
- A/R and A/P aging reports
- Inventory list & valuation

Legal & Corporate

- Articles of incorporation / operating agreement
- Business licenses & permits
- Client & vendor contracts

- Lease agreements (with assignment clauses)

✓ Operational

- Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)
- Employee roster + job descriptions
- Marketing & sales process documentation
- Software, equipment, and vendor list

3.4 Should You Sell Assets or Stock?

Factor	Asset Sale (Most Common SBA)	Stock Sale
Taxes for Seller	Higher taxes (ordinary income on assets)	Lower capital gains (favorable)
Taxes for Buyer	Depreciation benefits & fresh tax basis	Loses depreciation benefit
Legal Risk	Buyers assume fewer liabilities	Buyers assume existing liabilities
Use Case	Small businesses (under \$10M)	Larger corporations / C-corp structures

CRITICAL POINT —> If you relocate to Florida **before** sale —> federal capital gains only, **no state tax**.

4. Acquiring a Business in Florida (Step-by-Step Playbook)

Relocating isn't just about selling your current business — it's also about what comes next. The smartest strategy for many owners is a **“sell high-tax, buy Florida” transition**, where you exit a business in NY/NJ/CA/IL and acquire a similar or better business in Florida with lower taxes, less regulation, and better margins.

4.1 Step-by-Step Acquisition Framework

Step	Action	Output
1. Define Acquisition Criteria	Industry • EBITDA/SDE range • Geography • Role you want (owner-operator vs semi-absentee)	Written acquisition profile
2. Deal Sourcing	• Florida business brokers (BizBuySell, Empire Flippers, Transworld, etc.) • Off-market outreach (direct email/letters to owners) • CPA/attorney referrals • Franchise resale marketplaces	Deal pipeline & broker relationships
3. Initial Review & NDA	• Request CBR/CIM • Sign NDA • Review summary financials	Shortlist viable opportunities
4. Offer (LOI — Letter of Intent)	• Submit non-binding offer with price, terms, earnest money • Include due diligence timeline and contingencies	Signed LOI & exclusivity period
5. Due Diligence (30–90 days)	• Financial review (bank statements, tax returns) • Legal review (leases, contracts, licenses) • Operational review (employees, SOPs, vendor terms)	Final “Go or No-Go” decision

6. Financing & Closing	• SBA 7(a), seller financing, ROBS, HELOC, private equity • Draft Asset Purchase Agreement (APA) • Closing with attorney/escrow	Final ownership transfer
7. Transition & Growth Plan	• 30/60/90-day takeover plan • Marketing expansion in Florida • Optional — relocate team/family	Smooth handover + operational control

4.2 Sample Letter of Intent (LOI) Structure

LOI Includes:

1. Purchase Price & Terms

- Example: \$1,200,000 total — \$960,000 SBA loan + \$240,000 seller financing @ 6% over 5 years

2. Deal Structure

- Asset Purchase (all operating assets except cash & liabilities)

3. Earnest Money Deposit

- \$25,000 held in escrow

4. Due Diligence Period

- 45 days, extendable to 60

5. Seller Transition Agreement

- 60 days post-closing support + optional consulting paid hourly

6. Non-Compete

- Seller cannot compete within 50 miles for 5 years

7. Closing Date

- On or before XX/XX/2025

4.3 Financial Nursing: SBA Loans, Seller Financing & Equity

Financing Method	Typical Terms	Notes
SBA 7(a) Loan	10–20% down • 10-year term • ~2.75% over prime	Must buy 51%+ of company • Pro business relocation
Seller Financing	10–30% of deal • 5–7% interest • 3–7 years	Lowers upfront cash needed • Shows seller confidence
ROBS (Retirement Rollover)	Tax-free — use IRA/401k to buy a business	Legal if structured right • Needs specialist
HELOC or Home Equity Loan	Low interest • Based on home value	Often used for down payments
Private Investors/Partners	Equity split	Good for larger acquisitions (\$5M+)

4.4 Due Diligence Checklist (What to Verify)

Financial

- 3 years of tax returns
- 3 years of P&L, balance sheet, cash flow
- Bank statements (verify revenue & cash deposits)
- Debt schedule, payroll summary, AR/AP aging
- POS reports, merchant statements (credit card revenue)

Legal

- Business licenses, zoning approvals
- Lease agreements & assignability clauses
- Pending lawsuits, UCC filings, liens

✓ Operational

- Top 20 customers + revenue concentration
- Supplier/vendor contracts
- Employee contracts • Non-competes • PTO accruals
- Equipment lists & maintenance records

✓ Site / Physical Inspection

- Building condition • OSHA compliance • ADA compliance
- Review insurance policies (GL, Workers Comp, Property)

4.5 Transition Plan After Closing (30/60/90 Days)

Time	Objective	Example Actions
Day 1–30	Learn & Build Trust	Meet staff • Shadow owner • No major changes
Day 30–60	Small, non-disruptive improvements	Automate reports • Fix billing leaks • Minor marketing
Day 60–90	Growth Mode	Launch Florida marketing • Add service lines • Recruit

5. Florida Industries in Demand & Valuation Metrics

Florida attracts both in-state buyers and relocating business owners due to its recurring-revenue business models, year-round demand, booming population growth, and low taxes. Below is a breakdown of the most sought-after sectors, valuation ranges, deal sizes, and best geographic areas.

5.1 Top Industries & Typical Valuation Multiples

Industry / Business Type	Typical SDE/EBITDA Multiple	Median Deal Size	Buyer Appeal	Hot Florida Markets
HVAC / Home Services	3.0× – 4.5× SDE	\$500K–\$5 M	Recurring revenue, AC dependency	Tampa, Orlando, Sarasota
Pool Service / Maintenance	3.0× – 4.0× SDE	\$300K–\$1 .5M	Low overhead, subscription revenue	Palm Beach, Miami, Fort Myers
Landscaping / Lawn Care	2.8× – 4.0× SDE	\$200K–\$3 M	HOA contracts, year-round growth	Naples, Orlando, Jacksonville
Healthcare / Medspas / Clinics	4.0× – 6.0× EBITDA	\$700K–\$5 M	Aging population & high income	Palm Beach, Naples, Miami
Senior Care / Home Health	3.5× – 5.5× EBITDA	\$500K–\$4 M	Baby boomer migration	Sarasota, Fort Lauderdale
Restaurant / Hospitality	2.5× – 3.5× SDE	\$150K–\$2 M	Strong tourism & local demand	Miami, Orlando, Tampa
Franchise Resales	2.5× – 4.0× SDE	\$300K–\$2 M	Semi-absentee ownership possible	Statewide

Light Manufacturing / Distribution	4.0× – 6.0× EBITDA	\$1M–\$10 M	B2B stability, logistics hubs	Lakeland, Jacksonville
E-commerce + Fulfillment	2.5× – 4.0× SDE	\$250K–\$3 M	Low overhead, relocatable	Miami, Sarasota

5.2 Why These Industries Thrive in Florida

- ✓ **Weather Dependence** (HVAC, pool, roofing — constant demand)
 - ✓ **High Net Migration** (over 1,000 new residents per day in 2024)
 - ✓ **Retiree Population Boom** (healthcare, senior services)
 - ✓ **Business-Friendly Tax Environment** (no income tax, low regulatory barriers)
 - ✓ **Tourism & Hospitality Strength** (Orlando & Miami = top global markets)
 - ✓ **Year-Round Seasonality** (no “slow winters” like northern states)
-

5.3 Pricing Example — HVAC Company Acquisition in Florida

Metric	Value
Annual Revenue	\$2,400,000
SDE	\$550,000
Market Multiple	4.0×
Purchase Price	\$2.2M
Buyer Down Payment (10% SBA)	\$220,000
SBA Loan (10 years @ 9.5%)	~\$28,000/mo
Seller Financing (Optional 15%)	\$330,000 @ 6% over 5 years

Why buyers like it:

- ✓ 90%+ recurring service contract clients
 - ✓ Low customer concentration
 - ✓ Strong 12-month trailing revenue
-

5.4 Pricing Example — Medspa / Wellness Clinic in Palm Beach

Metric	Value
Annual Revenue	\$1,050,000
EBITDA	\$280,000
Market Multiple	5× EBITDA
Purchase Price	\$1,400,000
Financing	80% SBA / 10% cash / 10% seller note
Post-Tax Net Income (FL vs NJ)	\$252,000 vs \$222,000

5.5 Where Buyers Are Focusing in 2025

Metro Area	Opportunities	Notes
Palm Beach County	Medspas, clinics, wealth-focused services	High-income retirees & business owners
Miami / Fort Lauderdale	Hospitality, logistics, tech, franchise acquisitions	Immigrant capital, investors, tourism
Tampa / St. Pete	HVAC, roofing, pool companies, manufacturing	Fastest-growing metro for young families
Orlando	Tourism, entertainment services, home services	Convention & vacation capital
Naples / Sarasota	Senior care, boutique health & wellness	Wealthiest retiree market per capita

6. Advanced Tax, Residency & Legal Strategy

Relocating to Florida isn't just about moving your business — it's about legally establishing **domicile**, reducing or eliminating state income tax, protecting assets, and avoiding future audits or penalties from your former state (NY, NJ, CA, IL, etc.). This section shows exactly how.

6.1 Establishing Florida Residency (Domicile Checklist)

To avoid being taxed by your former state after relocating, you must clearly demonstrate **intent to permanently reside in Florida**.

Florida Residency Checklist:

Action	Must Be Completed
File Declaration of Domicile with county clerk	 Required
Obtain Florida driver's license (Class E)	 Within 30 days
Register all vehicles in Florida	
Register to vote in Florida	
File Form DR-501 for Florida Homestead Exemption (if purchasing a home)	
Move your primary home (sell/rent out old state residence)	 Strong evidence

Update **IRS address** via Form 8822



Transfer banking, doctors, attorneys to Florida

Recommended

Move family, pets, personal belongings

Strong evidence

Keep **logs proving 183+ days physically in Florida**

Critical for NY/NJ/CA

6.2 Avoiding High-Tax State Residency Audits

States like New York and California aggressively pursue former residents to continue taxing income.

They look at “Sticky Residency Factors”:

- Do you still have a home there?
- Where do you spend most of your time?
- Where does your spouse/kids live?
- Where are your doctors, clubs, religious memberships?
- Where is your primary business managed from?

Safeguard Strategy:

- Maintain **detailed day logs, receipts, GPS phone records, EZ-Pass data**
 - Keep <183 days in your former state each year
 - If selling your business, move residency **before the sale**, if possible
-

6.3 Capital Gains — How to Legally Pay \$0 in State Taxes

Scenario	Tax Impact
Sell while domiciled in NY/NJ/CA	Pay state tax (10–14.4% of gain)
Move to FL and sell after establishing residency	Pay 0% state tax
NY clawback?	Yes—unless residency clearly changed & ties broken

Example – \$3M Business Sale while living in Florida:

Item	Amount
Sale Price	\$3,000,000
Cost Basis	\$800,000
Capital Gain	\$2,200,000
Federal Capital Gains (20%)	-\$440,000
Net Investment Tax (3.8%)	-\$83,600
State Tax (NY)	-\$220,000 (if still NY resident)

State Tax (Florida) **\$0**

 **Savings** **\$220,000**

6.4 Entity Structuring When Re-Establishing in Florida

Entity Type	Best For	Pros	Cons
LLC (Single/Multi-Member)	Most small-medium acquisitions	Pass-through tax, flexible	Self-employment tax
S-Corporation	Service businesses, medspas, trades	Lower payroll taxes, 20% QBI deduction	Must pay “reasonable salary”
C-Corporation	Larger roll-ups, investors, franchises	21% flat federal tax rate	Double taxation if dividends
Series LLC / Holding Co.	Owning multiple businesses or assets	Liability protection between assets	Not recognized in all states

6.5 1031 Exchange & Asset Swap Strategies

You can defer capital gains tax when selling **real estate held for business use** and acquiring Florida property.

Example:

Sell warehouse in New Jersey → Use proceeds to acquire commercial property or medical-office building in Florida → Defer capital gains.

Requirements:

- Replacement property must be “like-kind”
 - 45 days to identify, 180 days to close
 - Use a qualified intermediary (QI)
-

6.6 Florida Homestead + Asset Protection Benefits**Florida Homestead Laws Offer:**

- **Creditor Protection:** Your primary residence cannot be seized by most creditors
- **\$50,000 Property Tax Exemption**
- **Save Our Homes Cap:** Annual increase in assessed value capped at 3%
- **Inheritance Protection:** Spouses/heirs protected from forced sale

7. Florida Relocation Checklist

A complete step-by-step roadmap covering business, personal, legal, and operational transition tasks.

✔ 7.1 Business Sale & Exit Preparation (Pre-Relocation)

Task	Status
Conduct business valuation & determine exit range	☐
Clean financials (3 years P&L, tax returns, add-backs)	☐
Hire CPA/tax strategist to plan sale timing	☐
Reduce owner-dependent operations via SOPs & staff training	☐
Engage business broker or investment banker	☐
Prepare Confidential Information Memorandum (CIM/CBR)	☐
Decide on asset vs stock sale with attorney	☐
Plan closing month strategically for tax reasons	☐

If relocating **before sale**, establish Florida residency (Section 6) ☐

7.2 Florida Entity Setup & Acquisition Preparation

Task	Timeline	Status
Register new entity on SunBiz.org	30–60 days pre-acq	☐
Obtain new EIN from IRS	Immediately after entity registration	☐
Open Florida business operating bank account	Within 1 week of EIN	☐
Apply for Florida Department of Revenue Sales & Use Tax Certificate (DR-1)	Before operating	☐
Confirm licenses required (DBPR, AHCA, construction, medical, etc.)	Variable	☐
Find/acquire target business (broker deals or off-market)	0–6 months	☐
Submit LOI, secure financing (SBA, seller carry, cash), enter due diligence	☐	

Execute **Asset Purchase Agreement (APA)** ☐

Close & begin business transfer ☐

 7.3 Legal Residency Transition — Avoiding “Sticky State Taxation”

Florida Residency Step	Required?	Status
File Declaration of Domicile in county courthouse		☐
Get Florida driver's license or ID		☐
Register vehicles in Florida		☐
Register to vote in Florida		☐
File Florida Homestead Exemption (DR-501) if buying a home		☐
Spend 183+ days/year in Florida		☐
File IRS Form 8822 (change of address)		☐
Move primary doctors, banks, CPA, attorneys to Florida	Strongly recommended	☐

Terminate voter registration & driver's license in prior state ☒

☐

☒ **7.4 Relocation: Personal & Operational Checklist**

Task	Status
Sell or rent out primary home in old state	☐
Choose Florida location (Palm Beach, Miami, Tampa, etc.)	☐
Secure housing (rent or buy) & apply homestead	☐
Research school districts / childcare if applicable	☐
Relocate family, pets, personal assets	☐
Update insurance policies: homeowners, flood, auto, life, business liability	☐
Hire licensed moving company (consider deductibility)	☐
Update estate planning documents to Florida-compliant versions	☐
Notify USPS, banks, IRS, subscriptions of address change	☐

✓ 7.5 Post-Acquisition & Integration Checklist (Florida Business)

Timeline	Task
Day 1–30	Meet team, vendors, top customers • Review SOPs • No drastic changes
Day 30–60	Start improving systems (CRM, bookkeeping, marketing) • Begin marketing for Florida expansion
Day 60–90	Scale operations • Consider hiring • Setup Florida tax filings • Transition payroll provider
Month 6+	Evaluate acquisition add-ons • Real estate purchase • Franchise expansion • Tax optimization

✓ 7.6 Optional: Business & Personal Insurance Checklist in Florida

Insurance Type	Notes
General Liability	Required for most businesses
Professional Liability (E&O)	Medical, consulting, real estate industries
Workers Compensation	Required if more than 4 employees (or 1 in construction)
Business Property / Equipment	Storm/hurricane-specific endorsements

Commercial Auto	If vehicles used for business
Flood Insurance (NFIP or private)	Recommended — standard property policies exclude
Windstorm / Hurricane	Critical in Palm Beach, Broward, Miami-Dade
Cyber Liability	If storing customer data or using online systems

8. Case Studies: Real-World Relocation & Acquisition Success

These scenarios are based on real transaction structures, financial outcomes, and relocation strategies used by owners transitioning from high-tax states to Florida.

Case Study 1: New York Restaurant Group → Miami Franchise Operator

Detail	Description
Seller's Original Business	3-location family-owned Italian restaurant in Westchester County, NY
Financials	\$3.2M revenue • \$580K SDE • Sold for 3.8× SDE = \$2.2M
Problem	High labor costs, 10.9% NY state/city taxes, rising rent
Solution	Sold New York locations → Acquired franchise rights for 4 fast-casual restaurants in Miami-Dade
Florida Acquisition	Purchase price: \$1.6M • \$320K (20%) down • SBA 7(a) financed 80%
Tax Impact	Seller moved residency 6 months pre-sale → Avoided ~\$200K NY State Tax
Outcome	Year-round tourism, lower payroll taxes, property ownership rather than leasing, lower food costs

 Case Study 2: New Jersey Physical Therapy Practice → Palm Beach Rehab & Wellness Center

Detail	Description
Original Business	Outpatient physical therapy practice in NJ (solo owner/PT)
Financials	\$1.1M revenue • \$300K EBITDA
Exit Multiple	Sold for 5× EBITDA = \$1.5M to private equity group
Relocation Strategy	Moved family & domicile to Boca Raton, FL → Purchased existing rehab clinic
Florida Acquisition	\$950K clinic producing \$280K cash flow • Seller financed 20%
Tax Comparison (Net After Sale)	NJ sale = 10.75% tax → \$150K owed vs. FL residency = \$0 state tax
Lifestyle Upgrade	Lower malpractice insurance, more Medicare patients, year-round demand from retirees
Owner Quote	“Same profession, but I kept \$100K+ in taxes and doubled my free time.”

 Case Study 3: Illinois Manufacturing Business → Tampa Distribution & E-Commerce

Detail	Description
Original Business	Metal fabrication company outside Chicago
Financials	\$4.5M revenue • \$850K EBITDA • Sold for 4.5× = \$3.8M
Issue	Regulation, union pressures, high property taxes, succession issues
Florida Re-Entry	Purchased B2B industrial supply & distribution business in Tampa
Acquisition Price	\$2.1M • 15% down + SBA 7(a) + 10% seller carry
Tax Advantage	Establishes FL LLC, income now taxed at 0% state level
Growth Strategy	Added Amazon & Shopify fulfillment → Revenue increased 40% in 12 months
Result	Moved supply chain to port of Tampa, no snow season disruptions, lower logistics costs

 Case Study 4: Tech Entrepreneur from California → Software + Service Roll-Up in Orlando

Detail	Description
--------	-------------

Original Business	SaaS productivity app company in San Francisco
Sale Price	\$6.5M (stock sale to private equity)
Tax Consideration	CA state income tax = 13.3% → Moved to Florida 8 months prior to close → Legally paid \$0 state tax
Post-Move Acquisition	Bought IT-managed service provider (MSP) in Orlando for \$1.3M
Deal Structure	10% down • 75% SBA Loan • 15% seller financing
Reason for Florida	Lower payroll costs, better cost of living for developers, pro-tech talent economy
Outcome	Built SaaS + services hybrid company • Acquired 2 more MSPs in Tampa & Jacksonville

9. Templates, Tools & Appendices

This section gives you copy/paste-ready tools: letters of intent, financial normalization templates, 183-day residency logs, broker lists, business search platforms, and more. You can use these immediately with minimal modification.

9.1 Sample Letter of Intent (LOI) – Business Acquisition

[Date]

[Seller Name]

[Business Name]

[Address]

Re: Letter of Intent to Acquire [Business Name]

Dear [Seller Name],

This Letter of Intent ("LOI") outlines the preliminary terms under which [Buyer Name / LLC Name] ("Buyer") proposes to acquire substantially all of the assets of [Business Name] ("Seller").

1. Purchase Price: \$[Amount], allocated as follows:

- 80% financed through SBA 7(a) loan
- 20% Seller Financing at 6% interest over 5 years
- Working capital adjustments to be finalized during due diligence

2. Structure: Asset Purchase (excluding cash, personal vehicles, and liabilities not expressly assumed).

3. Earnest Money: \$[Amount] deposited into escrow within 5 business days of LOI execution.

4. Due Diligence Period: 45 days, with access to financials, leases, contracts, payroll, tax returns, equipment lists, etc.

5. Closing Date: On or before [Date], subject to completion of due diligence and financing approval.

6. Transition: Seller agrees to provide 60 days of transition support at no charge, and optional consulting thereafter at \$[Rate]/hr.

7. Non-Compete: Seller agrees to a five (5) year non-compete within [X] miles of [City/County].

8. Confidentiality: Terms of this LOI and all business information shall remain confidential.

This LOI is non-binding except Sections 7-9.

Sincerely,

[Buyer Name], Managing Member

[Buyer LLC Name]

Accepted by: -----

[Seller Name]

9.2 EBITDA / SDE Add-Back Template (Copy to Google Sheets)

Category	Amount
Net Income (from P&L)	\$_____
	—
+ Owner Salary / Wages	\$_____
	—
+ Owner Health/Life Insurance	\$_____
	—
+ Family Wages (Non-Essential)	\$_____
	—
+ Depreciation / Amortization	\$_____
	—

+ Interest Expense	\$_____
	—
+ One-Time/Non-Recurring Costs	\$_____
	—
- Market Adjustment to Rent	(\$_____)
= Seller's Discretionary Earnings (SDE)	\$_____
	—

9.3 183-Day Residency Log (To Defend Against NY/NJ/CA Audits)

Date	Location (FL or Other)	Notes / Receipts (Flight, GPS, EZ-Pass, Bank Log)
Jan 5	Palm Beach, FL	Home (utility bill, credit card charge)
Jan 6	Palm Beach	Vehicle toll receipt, GPS log
Jan 10–12	New York	Business trip, 3 nights (hotel receipt)
...	...	...

✓ Keep proof: airline tickets, Uber receipts, cell phone records, toll records, bank/ATM transaction location.

✓ Target: **183+ days in Florida, <183 days in old state.**

9.4 Business-For-Sale Websites & Florida Broker List

Online Deal Search Platforms

Platform	Notes
BizBuySell.com	Largest nationwide inventory
BizQuest.com	Companion to BizBuySell
Transworld Business Advisors	Headquarters in West Palm Beach, FL
BusinessBroker.net	For smaller listings (\$100K–\$2M)
Empire Flippers	Online/e-commerce businesses
LoopNet	Businesses + commercial real estate
Flippa.com	Digital businesses

Florida-Based Business Brokers (Top Firms)

Broker Firm	Region	Notes
-------------	--------	-------

Transworld Business Advisors	Statewide	Largest FL brokerage network
Sunbelt Business Brokers	Tampa, Orlando, Miami	Mid-market focus
Business Brokers of Florida (BBFMLS.com)	Statewide MLS for businesses	Best off-market listings
Crowne Atlantic (Orlando)	Central FL	SBA-preferred listings
Calder Associates	Boca Raton	Works with \$2M–\$20M deals

9.5 Moving & Legal Contacts

Legal / Tax (Florida)

- Business Attorney: LLC, asset purchase agreement (APA)
- CPA/Tax Strategist: capital gains planning, residency audit protection
- Estate Attorney: Florida will, trust, homestead planning
- Registered Agent: Necessary for all Florida LLCs/Corps (SunBiz)

Logistics

- Florida movers: licensed & insured with FMCSA authority
- Insurance agents (homeowners, windstorm, flood, business liability)
- Commercial real estate contacts (for office/warehouse space)